WHICH IS THE

UNIT RATES / REAL-WORLD SHOPPING

BETTER DEAL?

Compare the prices. Check the quantities.
Make a decision you can explain.

PREVIEW

12 COMPARISONS	2 LEVELS	1 BUDGET CHALLENGE

Grades 6-7 | Printable PDF

Whole-dollar and decimal unit rates, realistic shopping choices, a reusable organizer, and a three-question exit ticket.

Includes worked solutions and teacher guidance.

All prices and stores are fictional. No sales tax or extra fees apply.

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Start with one unit

WORKED EXAMPLE

Name: _____ Date: _____

Store A sells 4 pens for $3.20. Store B sells 6 identical pens for $4.50. Which offer has the lower price per pen?

OFFER	CALCULATION	PRICE PER PEN
A	$3.20 ÷ 4	$0.80
B	$4.50 ÷ 6	$0.75

Decision: Offer B costs $0.05 less per pen.

Why divide? Dividing total price by the number of pens gives the cost of one pen. Now the two offers use the same unit.

Check the purchase: If you need 4 pens and have only $4.00, choose A. Offer B has the lower unit price, but its $4.50 pack exceeds your budget.

Before you decide
1. Compare the same item and quality.
2. Use the same unit for both offers.
3. Divide price by quantity and label the result.
4. Check the budget and required quantity.

All items in each comparison are the same quality. Buy whole packs only. Prices exclude tax and fees. The practice unit rates are exact to the cent; no rounding is needed.

PREVIEW

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Level 1: compare the offers

For each problem, calculate both unit rates and explain your choice.

Name: _____ Date: _____

01 Sketchbooks

A: 3 books for $12.00 | B: 5 books for $15.00

Compare dollars per book.

A unit rate: _____ B unit rate: _____

Work and explanation:

02 Glue sticks

A: 4 sticks for $8.00 | B: 6 sticks for $18.00

Compare dollars per stick.

A unit rate: _____ B unit rate: _____

Work and explanation:

03 Ribbon

A: 3 meters for $15.00 | B: 5 meters for $25.00

Compare dollars per meter.

A unit rate: _____ B unit rate: _____

Work and explanation:

PREVIEW

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The club supply challenge

BUY ENOUGH. STAY WITHIN $20.00.

Name: _____ Date: _____

Your club needs at least 24 snack bars, 24 juice boxes, and 24 pencils. Items are identical within each category. Buy whole packs, mix offers if useful, and do not pay tax or fees. Minimize the total amount spent.

ITEM	OFFER A	OFFER B
Snack bars	6 for $1.80	12 for $3.00
Juice boxes	8 for $2.40	12 for $4.20
Pencils	12 for $3.60	24 for $6.00

PREVIEW

1. Calculate all six unit prices. Show your work.

YOUR PLAN	PACKS / TOTAL ITEMS	COST
Snack bars		
Juice boxes		
Pencils		

2. Total spent: _____ Money left: _____

3. A third snack offer has 30 bars for $6.60. It has the lowest price per bar. Should it replace your snack choice if your goal is to spend as little as possible? Support your answer with costs.

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